SMALL-GROUP GUIDE

The Man Who Never Asked

The Man Born Blind · John 9:1–41

Text: John 9:1–41 (with Genesis 2:7; 2 Kings 20:20; Isaiah 8:6; John 10:1–18) **Big idea:** The light comes to the man who never asked, and goes looking for him after the room casts him out. **Time:** 60–75 minutes

Before you meet. Read John 9 in three sections: 1–12, 13–34, and 35–41. Mark Genesis 2:7, 2 Kings 20:20, Isaiah 8:6, and John 10:1–18. The goal is to see the man, hear his testimony, and name where we are in the room.

OPEN (5 MINUTES)

Pray. Read John 9:1–12 aloud. Ask: "What detail in this scene can you see, hear, or feel?" Let a few answers land.

OBSERVE (15 MINUTES)

1. **The question.** The disciples ask, "Who sinned, this man or his parents?" (John 9:2). What does that assume about suffering? Where is the man while they ask it?
2. **The mud and the pool.** Jesus sends the man to wash in Siloam, which means "Sent" (John 9:6–7). Why does John translate the name? What must the man do before he can see?

INTERPRET (20 MINUTES)

3. **The man's growing sight.** Trace what he calls Jesus: "the man called Jesus" (9:11), "a prophet" (9:17), a man "from God" (9:33), "Lord" (9:38). What causes each step?
4. **The parents.** Why are they afraid (John 9:22)? What does their silence cost them and their son? Where are we tempted to make the same trade?
5. **"One thing I know."** The man cannot answer every question, but he can say what happened (John 9:25). Why is that enough? What is the difference between testimony and a complete theology?
6. **Cast out and found.** The leaders throw him out; Jesus goes looking (John 9:34–38). What does that reveal about Jesus? What does the man see first when he can see?

APPLY (20 MINUTES)

7. **The room and the street.** Where have you been the disciples, the parents, or the man? Name one concrete step toward someone you have explained instead of loved.
8. **Your one thing.** If someone asked, "What has Jesus done for you?" what is your "one thing"? Say it in one or two sentences. Then name one person you will seek out this week.

CLOSE (5 MINUTES)

Invite each person to write down their "one thing" and the name of one person they will seek out. No one has to report it.

Pray: "Lord Jesus, you are the light of the world, and you walked toward a man who had no way to ask for help. Forgive us for turning suffering into a case file. Give us humility to say what we know and courage to say it when it costs. Thank you that when the world casts us out, you come looking. Open our eyes, then open our hands. Amen."

Remind them: the invitation is not "understand everything." It is "come to the light."

LEADER NOTES

- **Suffering and the glory of God.** Do not use John 9:3 to dismiss someone's pain. Jesus says it about this man, in this story. The Bible also gives lament (Psalm 88), unanswered prayer (2 Corinthians 12:7–10), and a God who weeps (John 11:35). Follow up if someone is in crisis.
- **The archaeology.** The Pool of Siloam is real; the healing is a claim the text asks you to trust. Model honest faith: evidence where we have it, trust where we do not.
- **The man's agency.** He never asks to be healed; Jesus takes the initiative. His faith is shown in going to the pool, not in earning the miracle.
- **The Pharisees.** John says the group was divided (9:16). The warning at the end (9:39–41) is for anyone who says "We see," including the church.
- **The parents.** Their fear was reasonable in a system that punished confession with expulsion. Do not shame the afraid; ask what fear is costing them.
- **The gospel.** The man is not saved by his argument. He is found by Jesus. End with the finding and the invitation, not "try harder."